70 I can use common adjectives

A Common opposites


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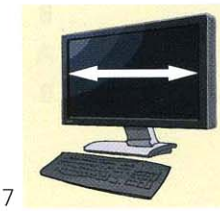


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1 She's **asleep.** OPP **awake**
2 The bird's **dead.** OPP **alive**
3 He's very **strong.** OPP **weak**
4 She's a **rich** woman. OPP **poor**
5 These are **common** names in Italy. OPP **unusual**
6 This Swiss knife's very **useful.** OPP **useless**
7 The screen is very **wide.** OPP **narrow**
8 The children are **noisy.** OPP **quiet**

spotlight **Position of adjectives**

Adjectives usually go before a noun. They can also go after **be**.
*It's a **quiet** village. The village is **quiet**.*
You can't use **alive, awake** and **asleep** before a noun.
*The man is **alive**.* NOT ~~*an alive man*~~

1 **True or false? Write *T* or *F*.**

▶ The River Nile is very narrow. F
1 Julius Caesar is still alive. _____
2 People are noisy at football matches. _____
3 Dictionaries are useless. _____
4 Some people talk when they're asleep. _____
5 Elephants are very strong. _____
6 America is a poor country. _____
7 Toyota cars are common in Japan. _____
8 Pasta is unusual in Italy. _____

2 **Write the opposite of the bold word.**

▶ They're very **rich.** poor
1 It's a **useless** knife. _____
2 My arms are quite **strong.** _____
3 Is he **alive?** _____
4 The people are very **poor.** _____
5 It's a **noisy** place. _____
6 It's a **quiet** town. _____
7 The garden's quite **wide.** _____
8 That's very **common.** _____
9 Is she **awake?** _____
10 It's quite a **narrow** road. _____

3 **Test yourself. Cover the words and look at the pictures. Say the adjectives and their opposites.**

B Classroom habits

Teachers:

Simon: I tell my students to write new words in a vocabulary notebook. I think it's really **helpful**.

Jill: It's very **annoying** when students are late for class.

Martin: When students do activities, I have to give **clear** instructions.

Carol: I don't like students who talk when I'm listening to other students. That's really **irritating**.

Students:

Petra: It's **impossible** to remember everything, so it's **necessary** to revise things you've studied in class.

Ivan: I write new words on my hand, and then on my arms. It's a **strange** thing to do, and some students think I'm **mad**.

Yoko: I repeat new words four or five times; **it's the only way** to remember.

Jean Pierre: In English, you often write words in one way and say them in another; it's very **confusing**.

4 **Write *SYN* (synonym) or *OPP* (opposite) next to each pair of words.**

▶ possible/impossible OPP

1 mad/crazy _____

2 annoying/irritating _____

3 necessary/unnecessary _____

4 clear/confusing _____

5 odd/strange _____

Glossary

helpful useful or giving help
annoying If something is annoying, it makes you a bit angry. SYN **irritating**
clear easy to understand OPP **confusing**
impossible not possible OPP **possible**
necessary If something is necessary, you must have it or do it. OPP **unnecessary**
strange unusual and perhaps not normal SYN **odd**
mad very unusual and not normal SYN **crazy**
it's the only way there is no other way

5 **Complete the sentences.**

▶ I've got two dictionaries. One of them is unnecessary.

1 His explanation was very _____; I didn't understand anything.

2 An old man in the street was very _____ and gave me directions.

3 It's _____ to fly round the world in five hours.

4 My brother has got three jobs, and works every day of the year. I think he's _____.

5 I was the _____ person to come by car; the others took the bus or walked.

6 Cookery books are useful, but they aren't _____.

7 My cat is very _____. He likes dog food more than cat food.

8 He gave me very _____ instructions to get to the house, so I had no problems.

9 My sister talks all the time when I'm watching TV: it's very _____.